Caramelized Onion Quiche

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

This quiche is all about the onions: soft, deeply caramelized and sweet, tucked into buttery pastry with a creamy cheese filling.

Serves 8 · Prep 20 min · Cook 1 h 30

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE PASTRY

- Approximately 350 g pâte brisée, homemade or ready-made
- A little flour, for rolling

FOR THE FILLING

- 1 kg white onions, peeled and thinly sliced into half-moons
- 3 tbsp butter, approximately 45 g
- ½ tsp salt, adjusted to taste
- 4 tbsp brown sugar
- 1 tsp finely chopped fresh rosemary
- 100 g bacon, fried until crisp, drained and crumbled, optional
- 3 large eggs
- 300 ml full-fat cream
- 75 g cheddar, grated
- 75 g Emmental, grated

FOR THE TOPPING

- 25 g Emmental, grated
- 50 g low-moisture mozzarella, grated
- 25 g cheddar, grated, reserved for the final layer

METHOD

1. On a lightly floured surface, roll the pâte brisée into a thin round, approximately 3 mm thick and large enough to line the base and sides of the tin. Ease it into place without stretching, trim the excess and lightly prick the base with a fork. Refrigerate for 20 minutes.
2. Preheat the oven to 200°C conventional / 180°C fan. Line the chilled pastry with baking paper and fill with baking beans.
3. Blind-bake for 15–20 minutes. Carefully remove the paper and beans, then bake for another 5–10 minutes, until the base is dry and lightly golden. Set aside.
4. Meanwhile, melt the butter in a large, heavy frying pan over medium-low heat. Add the onions and salt, tossing well to coat.
5. Cook for 25–35 minutes, stirring regularly, until the onions are completely soft and translucent and beginning to colour. Reduce the heat if they brown before softening.
6. Add the brown sugar and cook for approximately 10 minutes more, stirring frequently, until the onions are deeply golden and caramelized. Stir in the rosemary during the final minute.
7. Remove from the heat and fold in the crisp bacon crumbs, if using. Taste and adjust the seasoning, then allow to cool until lukewarm.
8. Reduce the oven temperature to 180°C conventional / 160°C fan.
9. In a large bowl, whisk together the eggs and cream. Fold in the cooled onion mixture, cheddar and Emmental, then add freshly ground black pepper.
10. Spoon the filling into the pastry case and spread evenly, leaving a little space below the rim.
11. Scatter over the topping in layers: Emmental first, then mozzarella, and always cheddar last.
12. Bake for 35–45 minutes, until the surface is golden, the edges are set and the centre has just a slight wobble rather than a liquid movement.
13. Leave to rest for 15–20 minutes before removing from the tin and slicing. Serve warm.

Tip

Give the onions time. They should be thoroughly soft before you add the sugar. Follow their texture and colour rather than the clock alone.